ten South East ASEAN countries signed the Treaty on the South East Asia Nuclear Weapon-Free Zone (SEANWFZ). As a key component of ZOPFAN, the SEANWFZ treaty expresses ASEAN's determination to contribute towards general and complete nuclear disarmament and the promotion of international peace and security. It also aims at protecting the region from environmental pollution and the hazards posed by the radioactive waste and other toxic materials. The SEANWFZ treaty came into force on 27 March 1997. The ASEAN is now negotiating with the five nuclear-weapon states on the terms of their accession to the protocol which lay down their commitments under the treaty.

8. ***ASEAN Vision 2020, Kuala Lumpur, 15 December 1997:*** The ASEAN vision 2020 was adopted by the member states of ASEAN on the 30th anniversary of ASEAN. They agreed on a shared vision of ASEAN as a concert of South East Asian nations, outward looking, living in peace, stability and prosperity, bonded together in partnership in dynamic development and in a community of caring societies.

9. ***Declaration of ASEAN Concord II, Bali, 7 October 2003:*** This Declaration upheld the resolve of the ASEAN member states to establish an ASEAN Community comprising three pillars: the ASEAN Security Community, the ASEAN Economic Community and the ASEAN Socio-Cultural Community.

In the economic sphere, the ASEAN Free Trade Area (AFTA), launched in 1992, is now in place. It aims at promoting the region's competitive advantage as a single production unit. The elimination of tariff and non-tariff barriers among the member countries is expected to promote greater economic efficiency, productivity, and competitiveness. A series of economic agreements followed, to ultimately reach the ASEAN Vision 2020 of ASEAN Economic Community by 2015. The prominent agreements are:

- Agreement on the Common Effective Preferential Tariff Scheme for the ASEAN Free Trade Area, Singapore, 28 January 1992.
- Framework Agreements on Enhancing ASEAN Economic